

Safety Instruction - Rotating Equipment Isolation and Restart Authorisation

1 Purpose

This safety instruction defines the minimum requirements before rotating equipment (pumps, compressors, fans and motors) is restarted after a protective trip, and before any field inspection of equipment that may start automatically.

2 Restart Authorisation After a Trip

A restart after a protective trip requires: (a) the first-out cause recorded in the shift log; (b) the initiating condition corrected and verified; (c) shift supervisor authorisation. Resetting a trip and restarting immediately without identifying the cause is prohibited. Protective trips and interlocks must never be bypassed to keep equipment running unless a bypass permit has been approved under the management of change procedure.

3 Field Inspection of Standby Equipment

Standby equipment can start automatically. Before any hands-on inspection of a standby pump or motor, apply lock-out/tag-out at the motor control center and verify zero energy. Visual inspection from a safe distance does not require isolation.

4 Vibration and Bearing Temperature Trips

Equipment that tripped on high vibration or high bearing temperature must not be restarted until reliability engineering has reviewed the vibration spectrum or the bearing condition.

5 Personal Protective Equipment

Hearing protection, safety glasses and gloves are required within the boiler feed pump and compressor enclosures. Hot surfaces above 60 degC must be treated as a burn hazard.